



OPENAI SOLUTIONS ENGINEERING

From fragmented supply-chain signals to governed decisions

A proposed OpenAI platform approach for Zeiss Supply Chain Management and IT leadership



TL;DR

OpenAI becomes the governed decision layer between ZEISS supply-chain data and operational action.

| Executive chat experience

| Enterprise integration and control layer

Problem

Context is split across SAP, logistics, suppliers and files.

Platform move

A central communication interface gives leaders **one decision surface**; the API integrates tools and controls.

Pilot

Start with one high-value workflow and validate faster triage, evidence quality and governed approvals.



Status quo and validation needs

Known operating context



- Advanced manufacturing, medical technology, quality and optics domains
- Decisions draw on SAP, supplier, logistics and document context
- Value depends on trustworthy answers, not another dashboard

Working pain hypothesis from technical discovery

- Risk reviews can start with roughly 20 minutes spent reconciling SAP, supplier, logistics and workbook updates before a decision can begin.
- When sources conflict, scarce domain experts become the bottleneck and escalation quality depends on who is available.
- The result is slower mitigation, avoidable expedite spend, schedule churn and unclear approval ownership.



Providing a decision framework for existing data

SAP

- POs
- Material master
- MRP exceptions

Warehouse

- EWM stock
- Goods receipts
- Production buffers

Carriers

- DHL / FedEx
- ETA changes
- Customs events

Suppliers

- Commit dates
- Capacity
- Quality status

Files

- Scorecards
- Excel trackers
- Contracts

PAIN

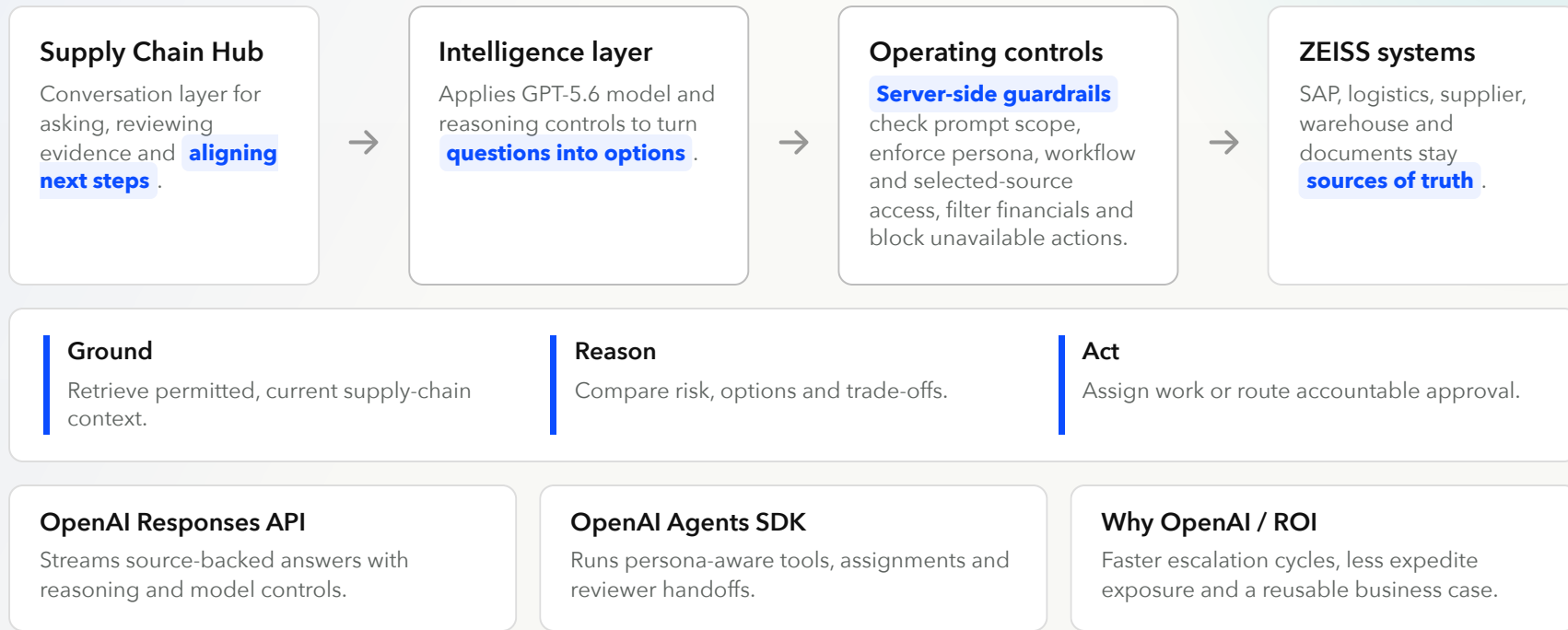
- Manual effort to reconstruct one trusted view
- Answer accuracy varies by source snapshot
- Low precision for lead-time and supplier risk
- Reliability depends on scarce experts

COST

- Expedite spend and buffers absorb uncertainty
- Leadership time shifts into escalation meetings
- Late mitigation creates schedule churn
- Scattered evidence increases quality exposure

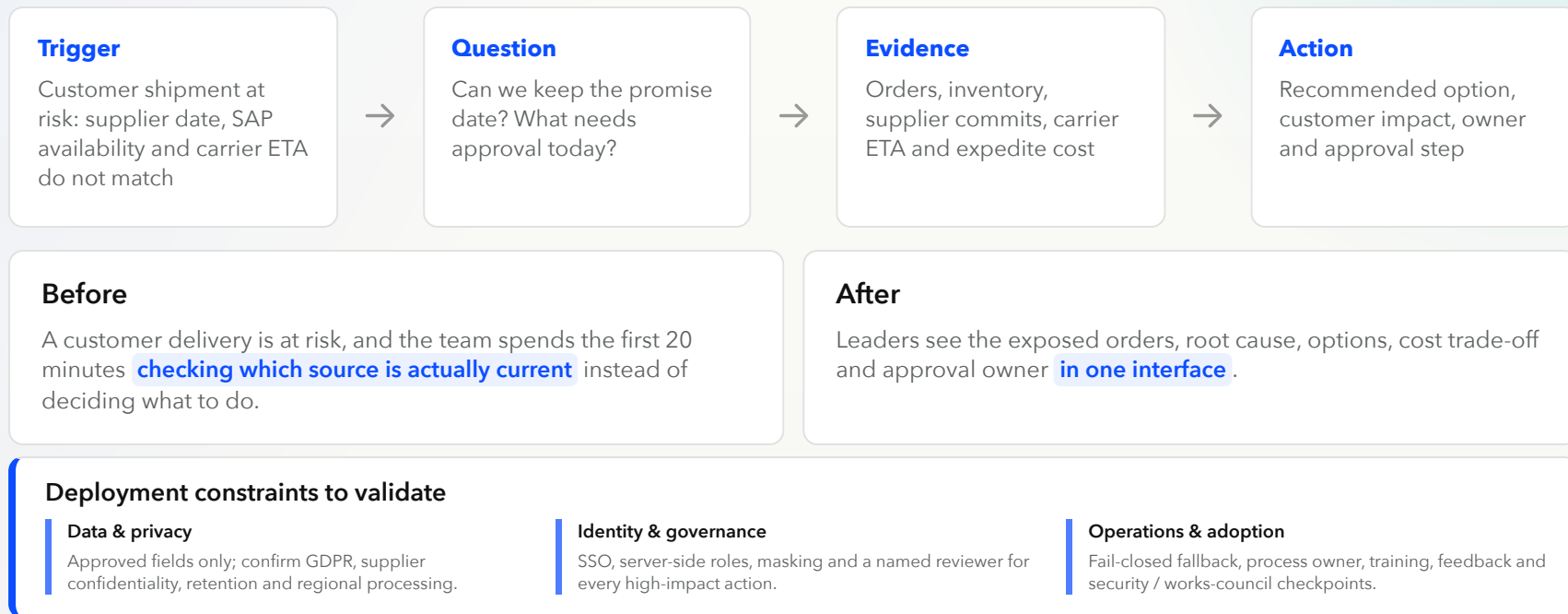


Solution overview





Executive workflow



Demo



Impact validation and success criteria

Validate value and control before scaling one workflow.

1

Annual value hypothesis · one workflow

€0.2M-€0.3M

Faster risk review

Fewer urgent expedites

Lower disruption exposure

ZEISS confirms the baseline, attribution and annual run cost.

2

POC decision gates

Test routine cases, high-impact exceptions and permission boundaries.

Process

**≥25% faster review · ≥80%
useful**

Decision quality

**≥90% source-backed · <5%
serious risks missed**

Technical reliability

**≥95% correct approved
system and workflow**

Governance

**100% human review for
high-impact actions**



Time to value

WEEK 0**Align**

Sponsor, workflow owner, success metrics, data boundaries.

WEEK 1**Connect**

Representative sources, role scopes, approval policy.

WEEK 2**Build**

App workflow, business tools, grounding and audit trail.

WEEK 3**Validate**

User feedback, answer quality checks, security review.

WEEK 4**Decide**

Impact readout, guardrail review, pilot recommendation.

After the POC**Weeks 5-8 • Pilot**

Harden one workflow and onboard the first team.

Weeks 9-12 • Adopt

Embed ownership, feedback and support.

Next • Scale the blueprint

Reuse the pattern across Procurement, Quality, Manufacturing and Finance.

How OpenAI can support adoption**Solutions Engineering**

Architecture, POC build and evals.

Enterprise support

Deployment readiness and escalation path.

Optional delivery services

Embedded help for production integration.

Annex



Behind the scenes

App experience

- Next.js App Router, React and strict TypeScript
- GPT-5.6 Sol, Terra and Luna with six reasoning levels
- Persona-aware tools, source settings, answer copy and feedback controls

Grounded chat and guardrails

- `/api/chat` runs prompt-scope checks before context, sources or tools
- Server context enforces role scope, selected sources and masked fields
- Responses streaming with deterministic workbook and demo fallbacks

Agentic actions and integrations

- `/api/actions` enforces persona, workflow and source eligibility
- Explicit assignee and reviewer metadata drives tasks and approvals
- Role-aware Microsoft 365 grouping, reviewer handoffs and trace flushing

Decision support and delivery

- Model-selected savings-relationship bubble or matrix; trusted records stay server-owned
- Server-derived decision colors align recommendations across both views
- Vitest, strict typecheck and OpenNext/Wrangler delivery to Cloudflare Workers